

STAGE SIXTEEN • WORKPLACE PROFESSIONALISM & ETHICS

FIRSTS

Workplace Professionalism & Workplace Readiness / Professional Ethics & Integrity

SESSION 1

Workplace Fundamentals

FIRSTS T1-T9

Workplace Orientation

- Genuine baseline knowledge every new role needs
- Ask directly, don't wait for it to become obvious
- Foundation for every FIRST in this stage

Professional Workplace Routine

- Reduces decision fatigue
- Builds a reputation for consistency
- You control it, not your inbox

Workplace Etiquette Awareness

- Often unwritten, still genuinely shapes perception
- Prior-context norms don't automatically transfer
- Observe before assuming

Professional Appearance Standard

- Norms vary significantly by industry
- No universal standard — confirm your specific context
- Avoids both under- and over-dressing

Workplace Punctuality Habit

- Simple, but among the most visible habits
- Consistency compounds into real trust
- Judged more than most people realize

Workplace Accountability Practice

- Ownership, not just task completion
- Matters most when something goes wrong
- Builds real trust with managers and peers

Workplace Ownership Experience

- Don't wait to be told for everything
- Solve what's genuinely within your judgment
- Builds real capability and trust

Workplace Initiative

- Beyond fixing — spotting real opportunities
- What separates proactive from merely reliable
- Nobody has to flag it first

Workplace Adaptation

- Deliberate effort, not automatic
- Prior norms and pace don't just transfer
- Closes out Section 1

SESSION 2

Navigating Workplace Situations

FIRSTS T10-T16

Workplace Policy Review

- Formal policy, not just informal culture
- Skimming ≠ absorbing
- Protects you from unknowingly violating a rule

Confidentiality Awareness

- Mishandling causes genuine harm
- Even unintentional slips matter
- Confirm status before sharing casually

Professional Boundary

- Protects wellbeing without damaging relationships
- Stated calmly, it builds credibility
- A boundary is itself a professional skill

Workplace Prioritization Exercise

- Not everything is equally urgent
- Confirm with your manager when stakes are high
- Guessing alone is a real risk

Workplace Escalation

- Know when it exceeds your level
- Clear and specific, not vague
- Prevents both under- and over-escalation

Workplace Mistake Recovery

- Recovery matters more than the mistake itself
- Neither hide it nor over-apologize
- Own it directly, focus on the fix

Workplace Accountability Conversation

- Not just top-down — a skill at every level
- Avoidance lets the pattern continue
- Closes out Section 2

SESSION 3

Performance & Professional Identity

FIRSTS T17-T25

Performance Review

- Prepare, don't just show up
- Real examples, real questions
- Changes the whole quality of the conversation

Performance Improvement Plan

- “Do better” isn't a plan
- Specific milestones, trackable progress
- Turns a vague worry into real action

Workplace Feedback Request

- Don't wait for the annual review
- Specific questions get specific answers
- Surfaces insight while it's still useful

Workplace Recognition

- A signal your work is landing as intended
- Reflect on what specifically earned it
- Lets you deliberately repeat it

Workplace Problem Ownership

- Reporting isn't the finish line
- Genuine ownership sees it through
- Beyond T7's proactive spirit — to resolution

Professional Reputation Audit

- Self-perception often differs from reality
- Ask someone who'll be genuinely honest
- An honest audit closes the real gap

Workplace Culture Analysis

- Stated values $\neq$ observed behavior
- Look past the handbook
- Helps you evaluate genuine fit

Workplace Readiness Assessment

- Honest, not assumed
- Reveals real gaps before they become problems
- Closes the loop on Sections 1-3

Professional Standard Statement

- Self-defined, not just externally imposed
- Holds even when no one's checking
- Revisited later in T41

SESSION 4

Ethical Foundations & Responsibilities

FIRSTS T26-T35

Professional Ethics Awareness

- Principles, not just rule-following
- Prepares you for what no policy covers
- Foundation for the rest of this section

Integrity Decision

- Awareness alone doesn't guarantee action
- Proven specifically under real pressure
- “No one would know” is the warning sign

Conflict of Interest Awareness

- Compromises judgment even unintentionally
- Disclose regardless of perceived objectivity
- Awareness lets you catch it early

Confidential Information Responsibility

- Ethical, not just a compliance checkbox
- Real trust is placed in you
- Extends T11 into an ethical framing

Data Ethics Awareness

- “Technically legal” $\neq$ “genuinely ethical”
- The gap matters increasingly everywhere
- Worth pausing on, not assuming

Technology Ethics Awareness

- Efficiency isn't the only measure
- Unintended consequences, considered upfront
- Extends data ethics more broadly

Intellectual Property Awareness

- Protects your work and others'
- Confirm your org's actual policy
- Don't assume automatic personal ownership

Citation & Attribution Practice

- Builds trust, respects real work
- Extends IP awareness into daily habit
- Credit genuinely, every time

Professional Honesty Challenge

- Easy when comfortable — the real test is otherwise
- Delaying usually makes it worse
- Proven in the uncomfortable moment

Ethical Dilemma Analysis

- Systematic, not just gut instinct
- Multiple values genuinely in conflict
- Closes out Section 4

SESSION 5

Applied Ethics & Integrity Reflection

FIRSTS T36-T45

Compliance Awareness

- Real legal and regulatory risk
- Related to, but distinct from, broader ethics
- Applies to your role, not just “someone else”

Responsible AI Awareness

- Accuracy, bias, disclosure — genuinely new questions
- Never assume AI output is automatically right
- Verify before you trust it

Privacy Awareness

- Distinct from general confidentiality
- Real ethical and legal weight
- Applies regardless of stated purpose

Accountability Under Pressure

- Easy without pressure — the real test is under it
- Especially pressure from authority
- Extends T27 into genuinely hard conditions

Ethical Leadership Reflection

- Principles, not just effectiveness
- Shapes how you'll lead under real pressure
- Extends the Stage Twelve leadership philosophy

Professional Integrity Reflection

- Actions vs. stated values — compare honestly
- Revisit your T25 standard statement
- Gaps develop quietly over time

Speak-Up Awareness

- Beyond your own conduct
- Know the real channels before you need them
- Don't assume there's no appropriate path

Ethical Decision Framework

- Repeatable, not reasoned from scratch each time
- Simple enough for a real, live moment
- Built from your own real experience

Professional Responsibility Statement

- Specific, not generic
- Distinct from your broader standard
- Keeps responsibilities visible and intentional

Integrity Audit

- Across the whole stage, not just this section
- Honest, even where it's uncomfortable
- Genuine strength and genuine gap, named

Stage Sixteen, Complete

One area of integrity strength, one genuine remaining gap, named out loud.